

YUE WANG

Room 4017, Lee Shau Kee Business Building, HKUST
ywangmk@connect.ust.hk • (+852) 60453121

(Most recent version)

EDUCATION BACKGROUND

Hong Kong University of Science and Technology

Ph.D., Quantitative Marketing

June 2026 (expected)

M.Phil., Quantitative Marketing

Sep 2022

University of Rochester

M.Sc., Business Research

2020

Information System, Simon Business School

University of Science and Technology of China

B.S., Statistics

2018

Statistics and Finance, School of Management

Exchange at the Washington University in St. Louis

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Substantive

Two-sided Market, Consumer Choice Dynamics, Media Influence, User Generated Content

Methodological

Machine Learning, Structural Modeling, Bayesian Estimation Methods, Causal Inference, Experiments

HONORS AND AWARDS

Best Paper Award, Asia-Pacific Marketing Academy Annual Conference (APMA) 2025

Runner-up, HKUST Business School PhD Student Conference 2025

Fellow, ISMS Marketing Science Doctoral Consortium 2025

SBM Dean's PhD Fellowship, HKUST 2023–2024

Postgraduate Scholarship, HKUST 2020–2025

Simon Business School Doctoral Fellowship 2018–2020

UGC Research Travel Award×3, HKUST 2022–2025

Outstanding Undergraduate Thesis Award, USTC 2018

Gold Award (Top 1%) and the Prize for Outstanding Young Talents, USTC 2014–2016

WORKING PAPERS

Yue Wang, Yi Zhao, Ying Zhao, “Demand Structure in Two-Sided Markets: A Network Based Revenue Analysis Approach” *Job Market Paper*

• **Best Paper Award**, *Asia-Pacific Marketing Academy Annual Conference (APMA) 2025*

Yue Wang, Ying Zhao, Yi Zhao, Yang Shi, “The Influence of News from Different Media Channels on Consumer Purchase: Insights from the Chinese Pharmaceutical Market”

• Reject & Resubmit at *Marketing Science*

Yue Wang, Ying Zhao, Min Zhao, “Show Me Some Effort! The Effect of Liking versus Comments and Their Presentation Format on User-Generated Content”

Yue Wang, Xiaobei Shen, Xiabing Zheng, “Ride The Wave or Not? The Spillover Effect of Online Shopping Festivals and Best Timing for Advertising”

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Understanding Demand Structure in the Two-Sided Markets: A Network Based Revenue Analysis Approach

ISMS Marketing Science Conference 2025

Washington DC

APMA Conference 2025

Shenzhen, Guangdong

Media Exposure and Consumer Preference: Understanding Consumer Choice Dynamics in the Pharmaceutical Market

ISMS Marketing Science Conference 2023

Miami FL

APMA Conference 2025

Shenzhen, Guangdong

Show Me Some Effort! The Effect of Liking versus Comments and Their Presentation Format on User-Generated Content

ACR Conference 2022

Denver CO

Ride The Wave or Not? The Spillover Effect of Online Shopping Festivals and Best Timing for Advertising

Inform's Annual Meeting 2023

Phoenix AZ

PROFESSIONAL & RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Eleme, Alibaba, Shanghai, China

Research Intern

Data Algorithm Group, mentored by Zhe Li

Apr 2024–Apr 2025

Foster School of Business, University of Washington, Seattle, WA

Research Assistant

Information System Department, supervised by Prof. Yong Tan

Aug 2017–Sep 2017

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Interests

Machine Learning in Marketing, Digital Marketing, Marketing Analytics, Quantitative Marketing Research, Marketing Management, Retailing

Teaching Assistant

Hong Kong University of Science and Technology

Retailing (*Undergraduate*)

Spring 2024

Marketing Management (*Undergraduate*)

Fall 2023

Consumer Behavior (*Undergraduate*)

Spring 2023

Consumer Behavior (*Undergraduate*)

Fall 2022

Retailing (*Undergraduate*)

Spring 2022

Marketing Analytics (*Undergraduate*)

Fall 2021

University of Rochester

Intro to Business Analytics (*Graduate*)

Fall A 2019

Social Media Analytics (*Graduate*)

Fall B 2019

RESEARCH COURSEWORKS

Hong Kong University of Science and Technology

MARK 6900 Quantitative Marketing

Ying Zhao

MARK 5420 Behavioral Decision Theory

A.V. Muthkrishnan

MARK 5520 Experimental Design and Analysis for Behavioral Research

Rongrong Zhou

MARK 6510 Current Topics in Consumer Research

Jiewen Hong

MARK 5410	Seminar in Quantitative Modeling	Song Lin
MKT 8633	Empirical Marketing Research (<i>at CityU</i>)	Joseph Ryoo
ECON 5630	Empirical Industrial Organization	Kohei Kawaguchi
MIMT 5310	Understanding Consumers: A Strategic Approach	Amy N. Dalton

University of Rochester

AEC 511	Advanced Price Theory I	Michael Raith
AEC 513	Industrial Organization Theory	Greg Shaffer; Heikki Rantakari
AEC 514	Game Theory	Heikki Rantakari
AEC 520	Advanced Causal Inference/Machine Learning	Paul Ellickson
ECON 484	Math Statistics/Econometrics	Nese Yildiz
ECON 485	Intro to Econometrics I	Bin Chen
ECON 487	Research in Applied Econometrics	Ronni Pavan
MSM 504	Theory of Probability & Stochastic	Henri Groenevelt
MSM 505	Theory of Probability & Stochastic II	Phillip Lederer
MSM 511	Advanced Topics in CIS and OM	Yaron Shaposhnik; Huaxia Rui
MSM 522	Optimization	Phillip Lederer
CIS 417	Introduction to Business Analytics	Rajiv M. Dewan
CIS 432	Predictive Analysis/Python	Yaron Shaposhnik
CIS 511	Research Topics and Methods in Information Systems	Huaxia Rui

SKILLS AND INTERESTS

Programming:	R, Python, PyTorch, Fortran, Stata, SAS, SQL, C, Tableau, Matlab, Mathematica
Language:	English (proficient), Mandarin Chinese (native)
Interests:	Piano (Level 8), Latin (Level 6), Folk Dance (Level 6), Musical Theory (Level 3), Salsa, Cha-cha, Rumba, Snowboarding

REFERENCES

Ying Zhao (Advisor)

Associate Professor
Department of Marketing
School of Business and Management
Hong Kong University of Science and Technology
Email: mkyzhao@ust.hk

Yi Zhao

Associate Professor
Department of Marketing
Robinson College of Business
Georgia State University
Email: yizhao@gsu.edu

Mengze Shi

Yuk-Shee Chan Professor of Business
Department of Marketing
School of Business and Management
Hong Kong University of Science and Technology
Email: mengzeshi@ust.hk

ABSTRACTS

“Demand Structure in Two-Sided Markets: A Network Based Revenue Analysis Approach.” with Yi Zhao, Ying Zhao (*Job Market Paper*)

Online food delivery platforms, a typical two-sided market, can be viewed as a network structure where restaurants serve multiple areas, and various areas are served by numerous restaurants on the platform. Within this network structure, the revenue contribution of a restaurant to the platform depends not only on its own generated income, but also on the revenue impacts it has on other restaurants through the network. Similarly, the revenue impact of a new product offering to a restaurant may vary depend on the restaurant

type and its position in the network. This paper proposes a network-based machine learning approach that integrates Variational Autoencoders (VAE), Graph Neural Networks (GNN), and Gated Recurrent Units (GRU) to capture the structure of the revenue in the two-sided markets, using online food delivery platform as an empirical context. VAE is employed to extract interpretable dimensions from the high-dimensional input vectors, GNN captures the network in the two-sided market considering multiple types of relationships, while GRU handles the network dynamics. The proposed model allows the platform to evaluate a seller by considering both its direct revenue generation and its revenue impact on neighboring sellers. Using the model structure, the platform can also assess the revenue impact of sellers' product offerings considering those offered by neighboring sellers. Simulations exercises based on the estimated model provides insights into platform's strategies for inviting new seller, as well as recommendations for product offerings to existing sellers on the platform.

“The Influence of News from Different Media Channels on Consumer Purchase: Insights from the Chinese Pharmaceutical Market.” with Ying Zhao, Yi Zhao, Yang Shi

Inferring the causal impact of news on consumer preference is challenging due to potential endogeneity issues, such as omitted variable bias and reverse causality. We leverage the unique context of the pharmaceutical market in China during COVID-19, characterized by high intensity and variation in news coverage across time and media channels regarding the effectiveness of Chinese medicine in combatting COVID-19, to make causal inferences about the differing impacts of news from various channels (TV, online news platforms and social media) on consumer preferences and purchasing behaviors in the pharmaceutical categories unrelated to COVID-19. During this period, a significant portion of news coverage is driven by external events related to research breakthroughs and clinical findings on the effectiveness of Chinese medicine. This provides strong instrument variables that enable us to address endogeneity concerns in making causal inferences. Our findings suggest that the three media channels affect consumer purchases differently. The popularity of the news on Chinese medicine from social media, irrespective of its sentiment, positively affects the sales of Chinese medicine. In contrast, both the popularity and positivity of news from online news platforms play a positive role. Further analysis suggests that these effects exhibit different interactive patterns with consumers' pre-existing preferences.

“Show Me Some Effort! The Effect of Liking versus Comments and Their Presentation Format on User-Generated Content.” with Ying Zhao, Min Zhao

Motivated by the challenge of content underprovision on social media platforms, the current work draws upon research on reciprocation and unpacking to examine the differentiating effect of feedback type (likes versus comments) and presentation format (packing versus unpacking) on user-generated content (UGC). Using field data from NetEase Cloud Music, the authors demonstrate empirically that comments from viewers are more effective than likes in motivating subsequent content generation, despite the greater number of likes. Addressing the natural confound in the field setting that comments are often viewed individually in an unpacked manner whereas likes are viewed in a packed format as a total number, the authors conducted two follow-up experiments to examine the effect of unpacking (i.e., displaying feedback as separate individual feedback). The results showed that holding feedback type and amount constant, presenting viewers' feedback in an unpacked format increases creators' subsequent content generation because of the increase in perceived effort behind the feedback under an unpacked format. Using a multi-method approach, this research provides insights into the motivation for UGC and offers actionable managerial implications in designing effective strategy for platforms to display feedback and elicit more engaged content generation.

“Ride the Wave or Not? The Spillover Effect of Online Shopping Festivals and Best Timing for Advertising.” with Xiaobei Shen, Xiabing Zheng

This study investigates the spillover effect of online shopping festivals (hosted by e-commerce platforms) on viewers' reactions to short-video advertising (on media platforms) using a natural experiment. As e-commerce shopping festivals are now spanning longer periods, coupled with firms having the ability to customize the release time of short-video ads on media platforms, it is valuable to explore how the spillover effect changes over time. We do find the existence of the spillover effect. During the warm-up and general-promotion periods of the shopping festival, the spillover effect is positive, resulting in increased click-through rates of ads. However, during the peak-promotion and post-promotion periods, the spillover effect becomes negative. We explain the spillover effect as a joint result of the stimulating effect of the festival's environmental cues and the inhibiting effect of financial constraints on consumers. The proposed theoretical mechanisms are verified through a field experiment and a post-hoc analysis. As firms can tailor the time to release their ads, they may ride the wave of exogenous e-commerce shopping festivals, but shall carefully choose the best timing for their advertising on media platforms.